

Frequency Check

SUMMIT TUITION · LUPIN · ONE-TO-ONE

Name: **Lupin**Date: **9 August 2026**Time: **≈ 25 min, 1 min per mark**Marks: **___ / 22**

Frequency Check

Apply the answer structures from your walkthrough sheet to every question below — check the mark count before you write.

Mia had checked the running order twice already, but she checked it a third time anyway, because the alternative was sitting still with the thought that kept circling back: the jingle file on the desk wasn't the one she remembered exporting. Radio club went live at four, and it was eleven minutes to.

"Two minutes to headphones on," said Dev, not looking up from the desk where he was arranging cue cards into an order only he understood. Dev had joined the club in September, six months after Mia, and still treated the studio like something that might ask him to leave if he touched the wrong dial. Mia hadn't corrected that impression, because it meant he double-checked everything, which was usually useful. Today it wasn't going to save her.

She opened the playlist folder again. There it was — *opening_jingle_FINAL.wav*, the file she'd exported on Tuesday after four attempts, the one Mr Whitfield had approved for broadcast. Except when she clicked it, what played back was six seconds of a half-finished loop with her own voice testing levels underneath it, the version from attempt two, not attempt four. Somewhere between Tuesday and now, someone — herself, probably, in a hurry — had saved the wrong file under the right name.

Dev noticed her face before she said anything. "What."

"Nothing." The word was out before she'd decided to say it. She could re-record something rough in the next ten minutes, something that would pass if nobody listened too closely, and nobody would need to know the approved version had gone missing. Or she could tell Mr Whitfield now, with the studio door still open and eight minutes on the clock, and watch him decide whether four months of Friday broadcasts had taught her anything about handling a mistake.

Dev was still watching her. "You've gone the colour of the mixing desk."

She thought about attempt two — her own voice, unpolished, checking levels, never meant for broadcast. Then she thought about what Mr Whitfield always said before every show: *a broadcast with a flaw somebody flags beats a broadcast with a flaw nobody catches until it's live*. She hadn't really believed him until this exact moment, with the wrong file open and the clock somehow now reading six minutes.

"Actually," Mia said, already standing, "I need to find Mr Whitfield." Dev's cue cards stayed exactly where they were, forgotten, as she went.

ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES — CHECK THE MARKS BEFORE YOU WRITE

1 — Retrieval (2 MARKS)

What did Mia discover when she clicked on *opening_jingle_FINAL.wav*?

2 — In your own words (3 MARKS)

In your own words, explain how the wrong file most likely ended up saved under the right name. Do not copy phrases directly from the passage.

3 — Explain / Why (3 MARKS)

Why does Mia say "Nothing" to Dev, even though something is clearly wrong?

4 — Vocabulary in context (2 MARKS)

In "Dev's cue cards stayed exactly where they were, **forgotten**," what does "forgotten" suggest about Mia's state of mind at that moment?

5 — Language / effect (4 MARKS)

Explore how the writer uses language to show Mia's growing anxiety in the third and fourth paragraphs. Refer closely to the language used.

6 — Character (4 MARKS)

What do we learn about Mia's character from this extract? Support your answer with two separate points, each backed by evidence.

7 — Structure (4 MARKS)

How does the writer build tension across the extract as a whole? Think about what the reader is told, and when.

MODEL ANSWERS & MARK SCHEME — MARK YOURSELF HONESTLY BEFORE
YOUR SESSION

Q1 — RETRIEVAL (2 MARKS)

- ✓ **Point 1:** Instead of the approved final jingle, the file contained a half-finished loop / an early test recording.
- ✓ **Point 2:** It included her own voice testing sound levels underneath it, from an earlier attempt (attempt two, not the approved attempt four).

Q2 — IN YOUR OWN WORDS (3 MARKS)

Sample answer: "Mia most likely made an error while saving her files in a rush — an earlier, unfinished recording got given the same file name as the version that was actually approved, so the wrong one overwrote it without her realising."

- ✓ **Point 1:** a mistake was made while saving, probably done quickly / carelessly.
- ✓ **Point 2:** the earlier, unapproved recording was mistakenly labelled with the final file's name.
- ✓ **Point 3:** this meant the correct file was replaced without anyone noticing at the time.

Check: did you avoid lifting "saved the wrong file under the right name" word-for-word? That exact phrase scores zero.

Q3 — EXPLAIN / WHY (3 MARKS)

- ✓ **Point:** Mia hides the problem instinctively rather than admitting it straight away.
- ✓ **Evidence:** "The word was out before she'd decided to say it."
- ✓ **Explain:** this shows the denial was an automatic reaction, not a considered choice — suggesting her instinct under pressure is to protect herself first, which sets up the character change the reader sees by the end of the extract.

Q4 — VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT (2 MARKS)

- ✓ **Technique/quote:** "forgotten" suggests something that has slipped completely out of someone's attention.
- ✓ **Effect:** applied to Dev's cue cards, it shows how completely Mia's focus has shifted away from the broadcast routine and onto the decision she's about to make — the ordinary details of the studio no longer matter to her.

Q5 — LANGUAGE / EFFECT (4 MARKS)

- ✓ **Point 1:** "the thought that kept circling back" — the verb "circling" suggests a repetitive, inescapable worry rather than a single doubt, creating an impression of mounting, uncontrollable anxiety.
- ✓ **Point 2:** "she checked it a third time anyway" — the repetition of checking behaviour (twice, then a third time) mirrors her anxious state through action rather than description, making her nervousness visible to the reader without being told directly.
- ✓ **Point 3:** "You've gone the colour of the mixing desk" — Dev's outside observation of a physical change (implying she has paled or greyed) confirms her internal panic is visible externally, reinforcing how serious the moment has become.
- ✓ **Point 4:** the short, clipped dialogue ("What." / "Nothing.") speeds up the pacing at exactly the tensest moment, mimicking Mia's own racing thoughts.

Q6 — CHARACTER (4 MARKS)

- ✓ **Point 1:** Mia is conscientious/thorough — shown by checking the running order three times before finding the problem, suggesting she takes her responsibilities seriously even under time pressure.
- ✓ **Point 2:** Mia is ultimately honest, even though it costs her — shown by her choosing to find Mr Whitfield with only six minutes left rather than covering the mistake up, suggesting that despite her first instinct to hide the problem, her sense of responsibility wins out.

Q7 — STRUCTURE (4 MARKS)

- ✓ **Point 1:** the writer opens with Mia's anxious triple-checking before revealing why, making the reader share her unease before understanding its cause.
- ✓ **Point 2:** the exact nature of the problem (the wrong file) is withheld until paragraph three, building curiosity in the opening paragraphs.
- ✓ **Point 3:** the countdown detail (eleven minutes, then eight, then six) is dropped in gradually across the extract, creating a ticking-clock sense of urgency that intensifies as the extract progresses.
- ✓ **Point 4:** Mia's decision is delayed until the final two paragraphs, so the reader experiences the same uncertainty about what she'll choose that she does, right up until she stands up to find Mr Whitfield.